

tar versus zip

You will ship trees as archives, homework drops, IP handoffs, backup snapshots

Create, list, extract

- Tar create with gzip is `tar c-z-f`, then the archive name, then the directory
- List with `t-z-f`; extract with `x-z-f`
- Zip uses `zip` dash-`r` to recurse, `unzip` dash-`l` to list, and `unzip` to extract
- Remember: `c` create, `x` extract, `t` list, `z` gzip, `f` file
- Exclude build and logs when packing a project so the archive stays small

Browser lab

[illegible]

Zip versus tar lab

Real shell practice

```
wsl - module20-zip-vs-tar/examples/tar_archives

# Track A - real Unix
# real shell session (Track A)

$ ls demo_dir/
file1.txt
file2.txt
subdir

$ tar czf /tmp/m20_demo.tar.gz demo_dir/

$ tar tzf /tmp/m20_demo.tar.gz
demo_dir/
demo_dir/file1.txt
demo_dir/file2.txt
demo_dir/subdir/
demo_dir/subdir/file3.txt

$ cd ../zip_archives

$ zip -r /tmp/m20_demo.zip demo_dir/
adding: demo_dir/ (stored 0%)
adding: demo_dir/file1.txt (stored 0%)
adding: demo_dir/file2.txt (stored 0%)
adding: demo_dir/subdir/ (stored 0%)
adding: demo_dir/subdir/file3.txt (stored 0%)

$ unzip -l /tmp/m20_demo.zip
Archive:  /tmp/m20_demo.zip
  Length      Date    Time    Name
  ----      -
      0  2026-07-18  16:34  demo_dir/
     38  2026-07-18  16:34  demo_dir/file1.txt
     38  2026-07-18  16:34  demo_dir/file2.txt
      0  2026-07-18  16:34  demo_dir/subdir/
     48  2026-07-18  16:34  demo_dir/subdir/file3.txt
  ----      -
    124
      5 files
```

Real shell — tar and zip

Real shell practice — try these

```
# ls demo_dir/ — see the sample tree to pack (tar_archives/)
ls demo_dir/
```

```
# tar czf ... — create a gzip-compressed tar of demo_dir
tar czf /tmp/m20_demo.tar.gz demo_dir/
```

```
# tar tzf ... — list archive contents without extracting
tar tzf /tmp/m20_demo.tar.gz
```

```
# cd ../zip_archives — switch to the zip example tree
cd ../zip_archives
```

```
# zip -r ... — create a recursive zip of demo_dir
zip -r /tmp/m20_demo.zip demo_dir/
```

```
# unzip -l ... — list zip contents without extracting
```

Pitfalls to watch

- The f flag's next argument is the archive filename, put options before the name carefully
- Prefer listing before extract so you know what will unpack
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, finish a few challenges after the starter
- On the real shell, create and list both a tar.gz and a zip
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to backup and clean-build